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Deputy Director, Head of The Office of the Intelligence and Security Committee

Cabinet Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Tuesday 17th November 2026

Cabinet Office

Reference number

487841

Salary

£86,000 - £110,000

The starting salary for external candidates is £105,000. Existing Civil Servants appointed on promotion will have their salary determined in line with standard Civil Service pay rules on the date of appointment. However, in the case of both existing civil servants at SCS1 and existing civil servants

applying on promotion, an exceptional starting pay case may be considered for those whose salary would otherwise fall below the advertised £105,000.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

SCS Pay Band 1

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

CO - Intelligence Security Committee

Type of role

Intelligence
Policy
Security
Senior leadership

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

If successful for this role you will be based in London. Occasional travel may be required.

About the job

Job summary

The Intelligence and Security Committee

The Intelligence and Security Committee of Parliament (ISC) was established under the Intelligence Services Act 1994. Its powers were reinforced in the Justice and Security Act 2013. Under the Justice and Security Act 2013 and the accompanying Memorandum of Understanding, the ISC has statutory responsibility for oversight of the policies, expenditure, administration and operations of MI5, MI6, GCHQ, Defence Intelligence, the National Cyber Force, the Joint Intelligence Organisation, the National Security Secretariat (NSS) and Homeland Security Group.

The Committee consists of nine Members, drawn from both Houses of Parliament. The members are nominated by the Prime Minister and appointed by parliament. The Chair of the Committee is elected by its Members. The Members are subject to Section 1(1)(b) of the Official Secrets Act 1989 and are routinely given access to highly classified material in carrying out their duties. The Committee takes evidence from Ministers, the Heads of the intelligence and security Agencies, senior officials, experts, and academics as it considers necessary. The Committee s evidence sessions are held in private due to the classified nature of the subject matter. Its Inquiries tend to concentrate on current events and issues of concern, and therefore focus on operational and policy matters, while its annual reports provide consideration of administration and finance.

The Office of The Intelligence and Security Committee

The Committee is supported in its work by the Office of The Intelligence and Security Committee, a team of analysts and investigators (including legal, technical and financial expertise where required). The Office of the

Intelligence and Security Committee of Parliament is currently a Cabinet Office Business Unit for administrative purposes, but the staff work directly for, and under the direction of, the Committee. (The Cabinet Office and Parliament are currently considering whether this administrative arrangement provides appropriate independence and whether alternative administrative arrangements would be appropriate.)

Job description

The Head of the Office of the Intelligence and Security Committee is responsible for supporting the committee in undertaking their statutory responsibilities, through:

- assisting the committee in determining its programme of enquiries;
- ensuring appropriate access to evidence and witnesses, including through providing or supervising the provision of policy analysis and background briefs;
- arranging and supporting formal and informal meetings of the committee, capturing appropriate records of discussions and ensuring follow-up;
- organising and accompanying the committee on domestic and overseas fact-finding visits where determined useful by the Committee;
- leading or supervising the preparation, drafting, and editing of final committee reports before they are formally presented to Parliament and the Government;
- managing relationships between the committee and its key external stakeholders, including the organisations overseen by the Committee;
- providing authoritative, politically impartial advice to the Committee Chair and Members regarding the statutory responsibilities of the Committee and parliamentary rules, privileges, and Standing Orders.

The Head of the Office is also responsible for ensuring appropriate management of the Office and the supporting infrastructure, through:

- recruiting and managing the staff to support the full range of the Committee's work (up to a ceiling of 30 FTE); fostering an inclusive, resilient team culture; and actively supporting staff wellbeing and professional development within a high-pressure, secure working environment;

managing the Budget for the Office, which has recently been increased to c£3.2M to ensure the Committee can undertake its work; and

working with Cabinet Office corporate teams and specialist IT providers to ensure the Committee has access to appropriate high classification estate and communications.

working with Cabinet Office and Parliament to ensure the Office of the ISC has the appropriate Governance arrangements to support the Committee's independent status.

Person specification

It is important that, through your CV and supporting statement, you provide evidence of the professional skills, breadth of experience and personal qualities for this post.

Essential Criteria:

Communication: Exceptional written English skills, with a track record of distilling vast, complex technical jargon into concise, accessible policy papers under tight deadlines.

Relationship Management: Strong interpersonal skills to deal directly with high-ranking military officials, ministers, and international dignitaries.

Personnel Management: A demonstrated ability to effectively lead strong, multi-skill teams, promoting team welfare, psychological safety, and workload resilience, particularly within fast-paced stressful operating environments.

Impartiality: Demonstrated ability to work in a strictly non-partisan, objective environment, supporting politicians across all political spectrums.

Excellent knowledge of, or a proven ability to rapidly master, complex areas within the responsibility of the Committee; and/or experience working within policy and experience of parliament or of the areas overseen by the Committee.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £86,000, Cabinet Office contributes £24,914 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

Whatever your role, we take your career and development seriously, and want to enable you to build a really successful career within the Department and wider Civil Service.

It is crucial that our employees have the right skills to develop their careers and meet the challenges ahead, and you ll benefit from regular performance and development reviews to ensure this development is ongoing. As a Civil Service employee, you ll be entitled to a large range of benefits.

This includes:

25 days annual leave on entry, increasing on a sliding scale to 30 days after 5 years service. This is in addition to 8 public holidays and one privilege day to mark the King's birthday.

A competitive contributory pension scheme that you can enter as soon as you join where we will make a significant contribution to the cost of your pension; where your contributions come out of your salary before any tax is taken; and where your pension will continue to provide valuable benefits for you and your family if you are too ill to continue to work or die before you retire;

Flexible working patterns including part-time or term-time working and access to Flexible Working Schemes allowing you to vary your working day as long as you work your total hours;

Generous paid maternity and paternity leave which is notably more than the statutory minimum offered by many other employers;

Childcare benefits (policy for new employees as of 5 April 2018): The government has introduced the Tax-Free Childcare (TFC) scheme. Working parents can open an online childcare account and for every £8 they pay in, the government adds £2, up to a maximum of £2000 a year for each child or £4000 for a disabled child. Parents then use the funds to pay for registered childcare. Existing employees may be able to continue to claim

childcare vouchers, so please check how the policy would work for you here;

Interest-free loans allowing you to spread the cost of an annual travel season ticket or a new bicycle;

The opportunity to use onsite facilities including fitness centres and staff canteens (where applicable);

Occupational sick pay.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

To apply for this post, you will need to complete the online application process, outlined below. This should be completed no later than **23:55pm, Tuesday 17th November 2026.**

1. A **CV** setting out your career history, with key responsibilities and achievements. Please ensure you have provided reasons for any gaps within the last two years.
2. A **Statement of Suitability** (no longer than 1000 words) explaining how you consider your personal skills, qualities and experience provide evidence of your suitability for the role, with particular reference to the essential criteria in the person specification.

Failure to complete both sections of the online application form (CV and Statement of Suitability) will mean the panel only have limited information on

which to assess your application against the criteria in the person specification.

As part of the online application process, you will be asked a number of diversity-related questions. If you do not wish to provide a declaration on any of the particular characteristics, you will have the option to select 'prefer not to say . See the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy for more information.

Should you encounter any issues with your online application please get in touch with us via:scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Shortlist

Your application will be acknowledged when it is received.A panel, will assess all applications to select those demonstrating the best fit with the role by considering the evidence provided against the criteria set out in the Person Specification section. Failure to address any or all of these may affect your application.

The sift and interview panel chair will be **Gisela Stuart First Civil Service Commissioner.** The other sift and interview panel members will be:

Vincent Devine, Government Chief Security Officer, Cabinet Office

Clare Bruton, Director, Parliamentary and Constitution Group, Cabinet Office

Dame Madeleiene Alessandri, Chair of the Joint Intelligence Committee, 2023-26

The timeline further down this page indicates the date by which decisions are expected to be made, and all shortlisted candidates will be advised of the outcome as soon as possible thereafter.

Assessment

If you are shortlisted, you will be invited to speak to both the **Chair and Deputy Chair of the Intelligence and Security Committee (ISC)** in advance of the interview to learn more about the role and organisation.
Please note this is not part of the formal assessment process.

You may also be invited to take part in a staff engagement exercise. This assessment will not result in a pass or fail decision. Rather, they are designed to support the panel s decision
making and highlight areas for the panel to explore further at interview. For more information about the assessment process, please follow this link: https://scs-assessments.co.uk/

You will be invited to attend a panel interview**,** in order to have a more in-depth discussion of your previous experience and professional competence in relation to the criteria set out in the Person Specification.

Full details of the assessment process will be made available to shortlisted candidates. If you are required to prepare a presentation for the final interview you will be given the subject in advance.

If we receive applications from more suitable candidates than we have vacancies for at this time, we may hold suitable applicants on a reserve list for 12 months, and future vacancies in the Civil Service requiring the same skills and experience could be offered to candidates on the reserve list without the need for a new competition.

Offer

Regardless of the outcome, we will notify all candidates as soon as possible.

We will send you a copy of any report for any assessment that you may have undergone as part of the recruitment process (if requested).

Indicative Timeline

We will try and offer as much flexibility as we can, but it may not be possible to offer alternative dates for assessments or interviews. You are therefore asked to note the below timetable, exercising flexibility through the recruitment and selection process, in order to meet the dates given. Please note that these dates may be subject to change.

The anticipated timetable is as follows:

Advert Closing Date: 23:55 Tuesday 17th November 2026

Shortlist: end week commencing 23rd November 2026

Assessment: week commencing 7th December 2026

Interview: week commencing 14th December 2026

Reasonable adjustments
If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service at: scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the assistance required section in the personal information page of your application form to provide information we should be aware of that will enable us to support you further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you re deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further information

Please note that this role requires **DV clearance**, which would normally need 10 years UK residency in the past 10 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible. More information about the vetting process can be found at the following link: https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/united-kingdom-security-vetting

Any move to Cabinet Office from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes,

including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at: https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a standard (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is developed vetting (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : SCS Recruitment Team

Email : scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission s Recruitment Principles.
If you feel that your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and wish to make a complaint, then in the first instance you should contact Government Recruitment Service at: cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk.
If you are not satisfied with the response that you receive, then you can contact the Civil Service Commission at: info@csc.gov.uk.
For further information on the Recruitment Principles, and bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission, please visit their website at: https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk.

Civil Service Commission

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